Motivation Statement – Fanelesibonge Dhladhla

Growing up in a rural area, I witnessed firsthand how limited access to technology and digital solutions holds communities back. Basic services that urban areas take for granted efficient record-keeping, accessible information, streamlined communication were either absent or poorly managed where I come from. It was this reality that ignited my passion for ICT Application Development. I did not choose this field for its career prospects alone. I chose it because I believe software has the power to close the gap between underserved communities and the opportunities they deserve.

I am currently in my final year of studying ICT Application Development, and this journey has equipped me with skills in building web services, REST APIs, cloud-based solutions, asynchronous programming, and database management. These are not just academic concepts to me they are tools I intend to use to build practical, real-world applications that solve real problems.

Upon graduation, my immediate goal is to secure a position as a software or application developer at a reputable company, where I can grow professionally, contribute meaningfully, and gain the industry experience necessary to eventually give back to communities like the one I grew up in. I am particularly interested in working on systems that improve service delivery, whether in healthcare, education, or public administration sectors that directly affect people in rural and underserved areas.

Funding my studies through this bursary would be transformative. As a student from a rural background with limited financial resources, this support is not simply helpful it is what makes the difference between completing my qualification and not. I am committed to finishing strong, and with financial stability secured, I can dedicate my full focus to my final year and exit as a skilled, job-ready developer who represents a strong return on this investment.

Regarding Missing Documents:

I was unable to submit formal downloadable versions of my Disclosure of Funding Sources and Disclosure of Study Debt. However, this is not due to a lack of funding disclosure or outstanding debt management on my part. In the case of my institution's portal, the formal document download function is currently unavailable because the institution is in the process of migrating to a newly developed student portal system screenshots confirming the relevant information have been included in my application. Regarding the NSFAS portal, a formal downloadable version of the funding disclosure has never been made available on the platform, the information exists and is visible within the portal, and I have submitted screenshots as evidence. I respectfully request that these screenshots be accepted as equivalent proof while the formal documents remain inaccessible through no fault of my own.